

Eben Upton spent many years trying to design prototypes of his own even as he continued working with global chip designer Broadcom. In his attempts to make a viable product he reached out to his university friend Pete Lomas who worked in hardware design at Norcott Technologies and David Braven, who was the co-creator of the old-school BBC Micro game Elite. The three of them joined their forces to create the Raspberry Pi Foundation that was tasked with the precise goal of making affordable pocket sized home computing set-ups that would engage and educate kids in computer programming. Within three years the Foundation had gone into mass production with the original Raspberry Pi Model B and followed it up with the cheaper Model A.

An Original Recipe

The conceptual basis of the Raspberry Pi was rooted in the early 1980 models of the BBC Micro computer systems. The 8-bit BBC Micro was created over 30 years ago by Acorn Computers for the British Broadcasting Corporation in its quest to promote computer literacy. As a part of the BBC Computer Literacy Project, the Micro was responsible for being an introduction to generations of children in Britain such as the creators of the Rasp-

berry Pi. And while the BBC Micro was sleek for its time it still had various drawbacks which the Raspberry Pi wished to improve upon for the current age. In order to achieve its goal of educating and making computing more accessible to children, the Raspberry Foundations turned to its potential users.



The BBC Micro served as inspiration for the Pi.

By bringing together an array of teachers, academics and programming enthusiasts, they were able to get as many insights into the needs of their future invention.

The core essentials of the project were always centred on affordability. Unlike the BBC Micro device of the 1980s, which was priced in hundreds